

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 96-195

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
SPRINGVILLE PUBLIC UTILITY DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
TULARE COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. Springville Public Utility District (hereafter Discharger) operates a wastewater treatment facility which currently serves an approximate population of 1500. Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) Order No. 81-050, adopted by the Board on 2 March 1981, prescribes requirements for discharge of treated wastewater from the facility.
2. Treatment is provided by an extended aeration activated sludge process, which is designed for a flow of 0.1 million gallons per day (mgd), and by a disinfection system. Sludge from the facility is hauled to the City of Porterville wastewater treatment facility. Monthly self-monitoring reports show that the monthly average flow at the facility is normally 0.04 to 0.06 mgd. In some months, average flows have exceeded 0.06 mgd. The facility has higher flows in winter than in summer, indicating inflow and infiltration. Order No. 81-050 limits flow from the facility to 0.06 mgd.
3. The facility does not have adequate disposal capacity. Disposal of wastewater occurs to two disposal ponds and a sandy trench. The Discharger initiated discharge to the trench in 1978 as a "temporary" measure of disposal as the capacity of the two disposal ponds is less than 0.06 mgd. The facility is adjacent to and west of the Tule River and adjacent to and east of an ephemeral stream. Order No. 81-050 describes an emergency disposal area of fenced pasture, adjacent to and north of the treatment plant. This disposal area has not been used for well over two years. The plant and the ponds are surrounded by an earthen dike which provides protection from 100-year floods. The sandy trench is outside the dike and within the 100-year flood plain of the river.
4. Discharge of wastewater to the disposal ponds and the trench poses a threat to the Tule River. Staff inspections of the facility reveal that either one or both ponds are typically operated at less than two feet of freeboard. The Discharger's self-monitoring reports also reveal that the ponds are often operated with less than two feet of freeboard, particularly during the winter months. The January, February, and March 1996 self-monitoring reports shows that Pond 1 had one-quarter foot of freeboard almost throughout the three months. There is a persistent threat of overflow from the ponds to the river.

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5. In addition to threat of overflow from the disposal ponds, the bottom of the disposal ponds and the trench are in hydraulic continuity with the ground water and, in turn, with the Tule River. Shallow ground water monitoring shows that the separation between the pond bottoms and the ground water is one to two feet. Samples of shallow wells adjacent to the ponds reveal water quality similar to water in the ponds. The percolated wastewater mounds below the ponds and, because of the close proximity of the ponds and the trench to the river, all percolated water eventually reaches the river. These requirements include specifications and limitations to protect both ground and surface waters.
6. Recognizing the limitations of the current disposal units, Order No. 81-050 includes a provision which requires the Discharger to provide disposal units in addition to the two disposal ponds. The Discharger was to have submitted a plan on providing additional disposal units by 1 July 1982, completed construction by 1 January 1985, and achieved full compliance with the provision by 1 February 1985. The Discharger failed to comply with these requirements. The Discharger has indicated several times that it is in the process of investigating disposal options but has yet to submit a plan and construct the additional units.
7. Since 1980 the Discharger has maintained a self-imposed moratorium on new connections to the facility because of limited disposal capacity.
8. The District diverts water for domestic purposes from the Tule River upstream of Springville.
9. Order No. 81-050 is not consistent with current plans and policies of the Board.
10. The Discharger's monitoring reports for 1995 show that the monthly average BOD of the effluent ranges from 5 mg/l to 114 mg/l. Settleable solids are less than 0.1 ml/l. The Discharger believes the high BOD reading may be due to laboratory error and recently switched laboratories.
11. The facility is in the northeast quarter of Section 11, T21S, R29E, MDB&M, as shown in Attachment A, which is part of this Order by reference. Surface water drainage is to the Tule River. The site lies within the Springville Hydrologic Area (No. 555.12) in the Southern Sierra Hydrologic Unit, as depicted on interagency hydrologic maps prepared by the Department of Water Resources in August 1986. Attachment B shows the facility site plan.

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12. The *Water Quality Control Plan for the Tulare Lake Basin, Second Edition* (hereafter Basin Plan), designates beneficial uses and contains water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.
13. The beneficial uses of the Tule River above Lake Success, as identified in the Basin Plan, include municipal and domestic supply; hydropower generation; water contact and non-contact water recreation; warm and cold fresh water habitat; wildlife habitat; preservation of rare and endangered species; fish spawning; and fresh water replenishment.
14. The beneficial uses of ground water in the area are domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.
15. On-site soils are river sands and gravels that are highly permeable.
16. The action to revise waste discharge requirements for this existing facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15301.
17. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
18. The Board, in public meeting on 8 August 1996, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.
19. The Discharger submitted plans and a request for revision of Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 96-195 on 12 September 1996 to reflect discharge to a third pond to be constructed in the area of the trench. The third pond will be protected from 100-year floods and provide for additional capacity to dispose of current flow. This reconstruction of existing facilities is exempt from CEQA in accordance with Title 14, CCR, Section 15302.
20. The Board in a public meeting on 6 December 1996, heard and considered all comments pertaining to revising this Order to allow use of the third pond.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 81-050 is rescinded and Springville Public Utility District, its agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in

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Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of waste to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. Discharge of waste within the 100-year flood plain of the Tule River is prohibited unless the disposal area is provided with protection against inundation or washout due to floods with a 100-year return period.
3. Bypass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited except as allowed in Provision E.2 of Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements.
4. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous' or 'designated', as defined in Sections 2521(a) and 2522(a) of Title 23, CCR, Section 2510, et seq., (hereafter Chapter 15) is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. The monthly average dry weather discharge shall not exceed 0.06 mgd.
2. The discharge shall remain within the designated treatment and disposal area, as shown in Attachment B, at all times.
3. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the wastewater treatment and disposal area.
4. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. B.3, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of wastewater in ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l.
5. The maximum conductivity (specific electrical conductance at 25° C, also EC) of the discharge shall not exceed the source water EC plus 300 μ mhos/cm.

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6. The effluent from the aeration unit shall not exceed the following limits:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Monthly Average</u>	<u>7-day Median</u>	<u>Daily Maximum</u>
BOD ₅ ¹	mg/l	40		80
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	40		80
Settleable Solids	ml/l	0.2		0.5
Total Coliform Organisms	MPN ² /100 ml		23	240

¹ Five-day, 20° Celsius biochemical oxygen demand.

² Most Probable Number

7. Ponds shall not have a pH less than 6.5 or greater than 8.5.
8. Ponds shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitos. In particular:
- An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.
 - Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.
 - Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the water surface.
9. Public contact with wastewater shall be precluded through such means as fences, signs, and other acceptable alternatives.
10. The ponds shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow and design seasonal precipitation and ancillary inflow and infiltration. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on total annual precipitation using a return period of 100 years, distributed monthly in accordance with historical rainfall patterns. Freeboard shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically to the lowest point of overflow).

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11. On or about 1 October of each year, available pond storage capacity shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specification B.10.

C. Sludge Disposal:

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner that is consistent with Chapter 15 and approved by the Executive Officer.
2. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice shall be reported to the Executive Officer **at least 90 days in advance** of the change.
3. Use and disposal of sewage sludge shall comply with existing federal and state laws and regulations, including permitting requirements and technical standards included in 40 CFR 503.

D. Surface Water Limitations:

The discharge of effluent to the ponds shall not cause the following in the Tule River:

1. Concentrations of dissolved oxygen to fall below 7.0 mg/l.
2. Oils, greases, waxes, or other materials to form a visible film or coating on the water surface or on the surface of objects.
3. Total ammonia (NH₃) to exceed toxic concentrations, as partially listed below:

	<u>Temperature, °C</u>						
	<u>0</u>	<u>5</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>15</u>	<u>20</u>	<u>25</u>	<u>30</u>
<u>pH</u>	<u>Total Ammonia (mg/l as NH₃¹)</u>						
6.50	2.5	2.4	2.2	2.2	1.5	1.0	0.73
6.75	2.5	2.4	2.2	2.2	1.5	1.0	0.73
7.00	2.5	2.4	2.2	2.2	1.5	1.0	0.74
7.25	2.5	2.4	2.2	2.2	1.5	1.0	0.74
7.50	2.5	2.4	2.2	2.2	1.5	1.0	0.74
7.75	2.3	2.2	2.1	2.0	1.4	0.99	0.71
8.00	1.5	1.4	1.4	1.3	0.93	0.66	0.47
8.25	0.87	0.82	0.78	0.76	0.54	0.39	0.28

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	<u>Temperature, °C</u>						
	<u>0</u>	<u>5</u>	<u>10</u>	<u>15</u>	<u>20</u>	<u>25</u>	<u>30</u>
<u>pH</u>	<u>Total Ammonia (mg/l as NH₃¹)</u>						
8.50	0.49	0.47	0.45	0.44	0.32	0.23	0.17
8.75	0.28	0.27	0.26	0.27	0.19	0.15	0.11
9.00	0.16	0.16	0.16	0.16	0.13	0.10	0.08

¹ To convert these values to mg/l as nitrogen (N), multiply by 0.882.

4. Oils, greases, waxes, floating materials (liquids, solids, foams, and scums) or suspended material to create a nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.
5. Toxic pollutants to be present in concentrations that produce detrimental physiological responses in human, plant, animal, or aquatic life.
6. Aesthetically undesirable discoloration.
7. Fungi, slimes, or other objectionable growths.
8. Turbidity to increase more than 1 NTU over background levels when background levels are between 0 and 5 NTU, 20% over background levels when the background levels are between 5 and 50 NTU, 10 NTU over background levels when background levels are between 50 and 100 NTU, and 10% over background levels when the background level is greater than 100 NTU.
9. The normal ambient pH to fall below 6.5, exceed 8.3, or change by more than 0.3 units.
10. Deposition of materials that cause nuisance conditions or adversely affect beneficial uses.
11. The normal ambient temperature to increase more than 2.8 °C (5 °F).
12. Taste or odor-producing substances to impart undesirable tastes or odors to fish flesh or other edible products of aquatic origin or to cause nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.

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13. The fecal coliform concentration based on a minimum of not less than five samples for any 30-day period to exceed a geometric mean of 200 MPN/100 ml or cause more than 10% of total samples to exceed 400 MPN/100 ml.
14. Radionuclides to be present in concentrations that exceed maximum contaminant levels specified in Title 22, CCR; that harm human, plant, animal or aquatic life; or that result in the accumulation of radionuclides in the food web to an extent that presents a hazard to human, plant, animal, or aquatic life.
15. Toxic pollutants to be present in water columns, sediments, or biota in concentrations that adversely affect beneficial uses; that produce detrimental physiological responses in human, plant, animal, or aquatic life.
16. Violations of any applicable water quality standard for receiving waters adopted by the Board or the State Water Resources Control Board pursuant to the CWA and regulations adopted thereunder.
17. Chemical constituents in concentrations that adversely affect beneficial uses.

E. Ground Water Limitations:

The discharge, in combination with other sources, shall not cause underlying ground water at the edge of the Discharger's property boundary to contain waste constituents in concentrations statistically greater than background water quality.

F. Provisions:

1. The Discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 96-195, which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall not allow pollutant free wastewater to be discharged into the collection, treatment, and disposal system in amounts that significantly diminish the system's capability to comply with this Order. Pollutant-free wastewater means rainfall, ground water, cooling waters, and condensates that without treatment are essentially free of pollutants.
3. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated 1 March 1991, which are

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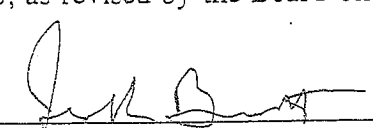
attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."

4. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.

To assume operation under this Order, the succeeding owner or operator must apply in writing to the Executive Officer requesting transfer of the Order. The request must contain the requesting entity's full legal name, the State of incorporation if a corporation, the name and address and telephone number of the persons responsible for contact with the Board, and a statement. The statement shall comply with the signatory paragraph of Standard Provision B.3 and state that the new owner or operator assumes full responsibility for compliance with this Order. Failure to submit the request shall be considered a discharge without requirements, a violation of the California Water Code. Transfer shall be approved or disapproved by the Executive Officer.

5. The Discharger must comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.
6. A copy of this Order shall be kept at the discharge facility for reference by wastewater treatment plant operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
7. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

I, JAMES R. BENNETT, Interim Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 8 August 1996, as revised by the Board on 6 December 1996.



JAMES R. BENNETT, Interim Executive Officer

SH:sh/rac

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 96-195

FOR
SPRINGVILLE PUBLIC UTILITY DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
TULARE COUNTY

Specific sample station locations shall be established with concurrence of the Board's staff, and a description of the stations shall be submitted to Board and attached to this Program.

INFLUENT MONITORING

Influent samples shall be collected at the inlet of the headworks and approximately the same time as an effluent sample. Influent monitoring shall include the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Measurement</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Flow	mgd	Metered	Continuously
BOD ₅	mg/l	Grab	Quarterly

EFFLUENT MONITORING

Effluent samples shall be collected at the outlet of the last treatment unit prior to discharge to the disposal ponds. Effluent samples shall be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge. Time of collection of a grab sample shall be recorded. Effluent monitoring shall include the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Measurement</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Flow	mgd	Estimate	Daily
Chlorine Residual	mg/l	Grab	Daily
Settleable Solids	ml/l	Grab	3/week
pH	pH Units	Grab	Weekly
BOD ₅	mg/l	Grab	Weekly
EC	μ mhos/cm	Grab	Weekly

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EFFLUENT MONITORING - Continued

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Measurement</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Total Coliform Organisms	MPN/100 ml	Grab	3/week

SURFACE WATER MONITORING

Tule River shall be monitored to ascertain the effect of discharge from the facility on the river. Surface water monitoring shall include the following:

<u>Station</u>	<u>Description</u>
R-1	300 feet upstream from the most upstream disposal pond
R-2	300 feet downstream from the most downstream disposal pond

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Station</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Total Nitrogen	mg/l	R-1, R-2	Quarterly
Fecal Coliform Organisms	MPN/100 ml	R-1, R-2	Quarterly

POND MONITORING

The freeboard shall be monitored on all ponds to the nearest tenth of a foot. Pond monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Measurement</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Dissolved Oxygen ¹	mg/l	Grab	Weekly
Freeboard	feet	Observation	Weekly

¹ Samples shall be collected from each pond near the outlet and analyzed for dissolved oxygen. Samples shall be collected between 0800 and 0900 hours.

Permanent markers shall be placed in the ponds with calibration indicating the water level at design capacity and available operational freeboard.

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In addition, the Discharger shall inspect the condition of the ponds once per week and write visual observation in a bound log book. Notations shall include observations of whether weeds are developing in the water or along the bank, and their location; whether dead algae, vegetation, scum, or debris are accumulating on the pond surface and their location; whether burrowing animals or insects are present; and the color of the ponds (e.g., dark sparkling green, dull green, yellow, grey, tan, brown, etc.). A copy of the entries made in the log during each month shall be submitted along with the monitoring report the following month. Where the O&M manual indicates remedial action is necessary, the Discharger shall briefly explain in the transmittal what action has been taken or is scheduled to be taken.

GROUND WATER MONITORING

The ground water wells existing at the facility shall be monitored for the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Measurement</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Depth	feet	Observation	Monthly
pH	pH Units	Grab	Monthly
EC	μ mhos/cm	Grab	Monthly
Total Coliform Organisms	MPN ¹ /100 ml	Grab	Quarterly

¹ Most Probable Number

REPORTING

Daily, weekly, and monthly monitoring data shall be reported in monthly monitoring reports. Monthly monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Board by the **20th day of the following month**. Quarterly monitoring data shall be reported in the quarterly monitoring reports which are to be submitted by the 20th day of the month following the calendar quarter. Annual monitoring reports shall be submitted by **31 January of each year**.

In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner that illustrates clearly whether the Discharger complies with waste discharge requirements.

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If the Discharger monitors any pollutant at the locations designated herein more frequently than is required by this Order, the results of such monitoring shall be included in the discharge monitoring report.

The Discharger may also be requested to submit an annual report to the Board with tabular and graphical summaries of the monitoring data obtained during the previous year. Any such request shall be made in writing. The report shall discuss the corrective actions taken and planned to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

By 31 January of each year, the Discharger shall submit a written report to the Executive Officer containing the following:

- a. The names, certificate grades, and general responsibilities of all persons in charge of wastewater treatment and disposal (Standard Provision A.5).
- b. The names and telephone numbers of persons to contact regarding wastewater disposal for emergency and routine situations.
- c. A statement certifying when the flow meter and other monitoring instruments and devices were last calibrated, including identification of who performed the calibration (Standard Provision C.6).
- d. A statement certifying whether the current operation and maintenance manual, and contingency plan, reflect the wastewater treatment plant as currently constructed and operated, and the dates when these documents were last revised and last reviewed for adequacy.

All reports submitted in response to this Order shall comply with the signatory requirements in Standard Provision B.3.

This program was not revised on 6 December 1996, and the Discharger shall continue to implement the above monitoring program that became effective the first day of September 1996.

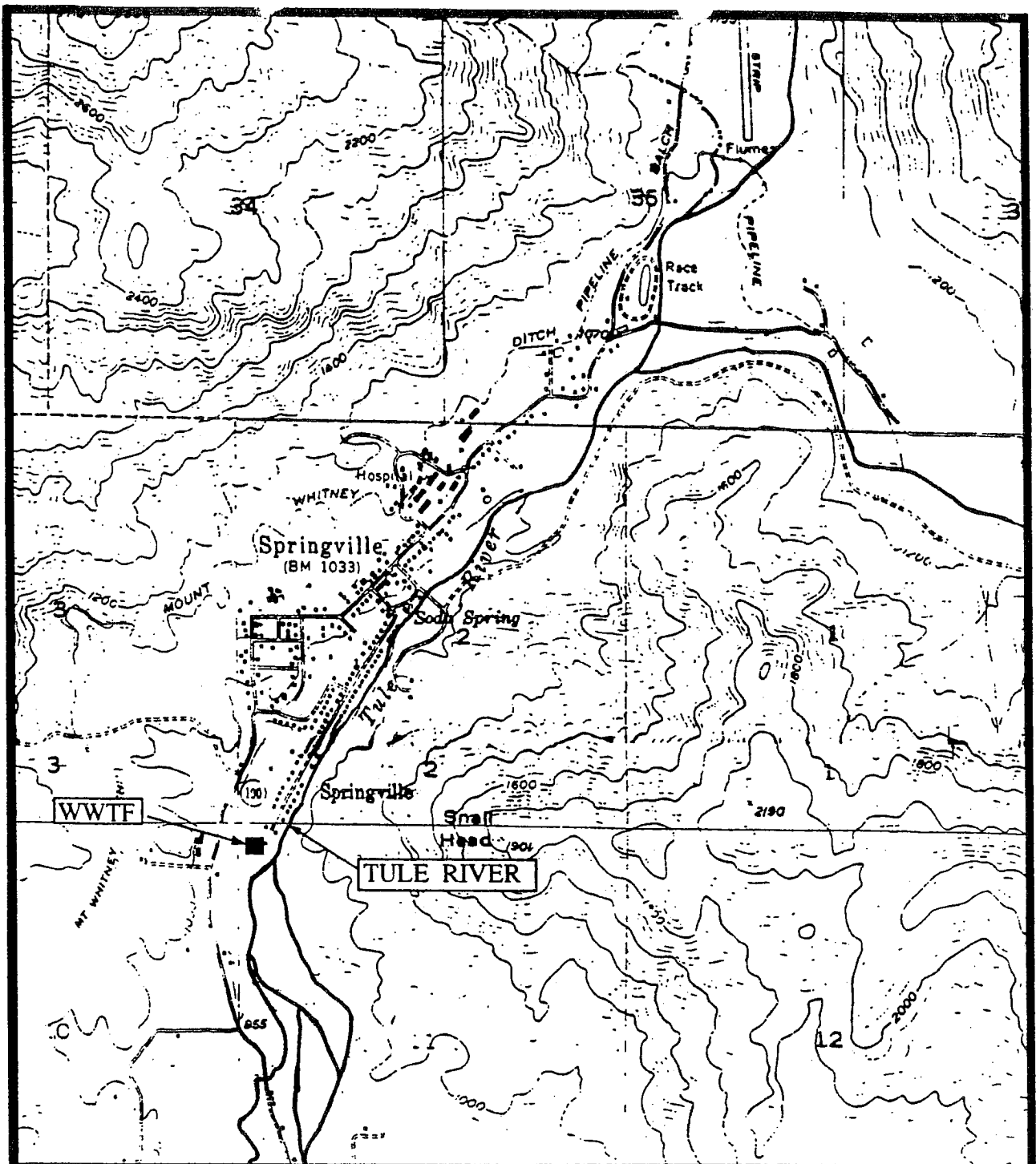
Ordered by: _____

JAMES R. BENNETT, Interim Executive Officer

6 December 1996

(Date)

SH:sh/rac



ATTACHMENT A

Vicinity Map

SPRINGVILLE PUBLIC UTILITY DISTRICT WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY TULARE COUNTY

Section 11, T21S, R29E, MDB&M
Springville and Globe, 7.5' USGS Quad

Scale 1" = 2000'

SLUDGE
BED



ACTIVATED SLUDGE PLANT



CHLORINE CONTACT



POND 1

POND 2

POND 3

WELL 2

WELL 1

TULE RIVER



DESIGNATED
DISPOSAL AREA

ATTACHMENT B

Site Plan

(As Revised on 6 December 1996)

SPRINGVILLE PUBLIC UTILITY DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
TULARE COUNTY

(Not to Scale)

INFORMATION SHEET

SPRINGVILLE PUBLIC UTILITY DISTRICT WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY TULARE COUNTY

Springville Public Utility District operates a wastewater treatment facility consisting of an activated sludge treatment unit and a disinfection system. Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 81-050 prescribes requirements for the facility. Disposal of effluent is to two ponds and a sandy trench. The facility is adjacent to the Tule River on the east and an ephemeral stream on the west. The activated sludge treatment plant is designed for a flow of 0.1 mgd. Order No. 81-050 limits flows from the facility to 0.06 mgd. The facility's disposal capacity is less than 0.06 mgd. Due to the limited disposal capacity, the Discharger initiated discharge to the sandy trench in 1978 as a temporary method of disposal and, since then, the Discharger has continued using the trench. Discharge of wastewater to the disposal ponds and the trench poses a significant threat to the Tule River. The ponds at the facility are often operated full, especially during the winter months, resulting in a threat of overflow to the river. Also, the bottoms of the ponds are in hydraulic continuity with the ground water, which is one to two feet below ground surface, and with the river.

The Discharger failed to comply with the time schedule specified in Order No. 81-050 to increase disposal capacity. According to Provision B.2, the Discharger was to have submitted a plan by 1 July 1982 on providing disposal units in addition to the two ponds, completed construction by 1 January 1985, and achieved full compliance with the provision by 1 February 1985. The Discharger issued a moratorium in 1980 for new connections to the sewer system. The Discharger has indicated several times that disposal options are being studied, but after 15 years it is still reviewing disposal options.

The beneficial uses of the Tule River above Lake Success, include municipal and domestic supply; hydropower generation; water contact and non-contact water recreation; warm and cold fresh water habitat; wildlife habitat; preservation of rare and endangered species; fish spawning; and fresh water replenishment.

Ground water monitoring at the facility shows that ground water is about two feet below ground surface. The beneficial uses of ground water in the area are domestic and agricultural supply.

On-site soils are river sands and gravel that are highly permeable.

The Order includes discharge specifications and provisions which govern discharges to land. Since there is a potential threat to the Tule River because of the proximity of the ponds to the river, the Order includes coliform limitation of the discharge. Also, surface water limitations are included because of potential indirect discharges to the river.

INFORMATION SHEET - Continued

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The Order prohibits discharge to an area not protected against inundation or washout due to 100-year floods.

The Order requires the Discharger to monitor Tule River to ascertain the effect of discharge at the facility on the river.

The action to revise waste discharge requirements for this existing facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15301.

SH:sh/rac:12/6/96

